

LITTLE READERS

A 46-Hour EFL Reading Program for Young Learners (Ages 5–8)

Designed by

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Section 1: Executive Overview

1.1 Program Description

LITTLE READERS is a structured 46-hour English as a Foreign Language (EFL) reading program purpose-built for young learners between the ages of 5 and 8. The program takes children from pre-reading awareness through emergent reading, early decoding, foundational fluency, and introductory comprehension — all within a developmentally appropriate, research-aligned, and play-rich instructional environment.

The curriculum unfolds across six thematic units, each targeting a distinct pillar of early literacy: Print Awareness, Phonological & Phonemic Awareness, Systematic Phonics, High-Frequency Word Recognition, Reading Fluency, and Reading Comprehension. Every unit builds directly on the previous one, creating a coherent and cumulative learning journey. The program is specifically designed for non-English-speaking contexts where English is learned as a foreign language, meaning extra care is taken to build both decoding skill and oral language support simultaneously.

1.2 Instructional Design Framework

This program integrates seven evidence-based instructional design frameworks. Rather than relying on a single model, the integration of these approaches produces a richer, more responsive design that serves the full range of young EFL learners.

1.2.1 ADDIE Model (Overarching Process Framework)

ADDIE — Analysis, Design, Development, Implementation, Evaluation — serves as the primary scaffolding model for the program's creation and delivery. Each phase shaped a specific layer of the curriculum:

1. **Analysis:** Learner profiles were mapped across the 5–8 age range, accounting for variable L1 literacy, cognitive development stage, and zero to minimal prior English reading experience. Contextual factors (EFL environment, class size, available resources) were identified. A full gap analysis was conducted to define the entry and exit competency states.
2. **Design:** Learning outcomes were written using Bloom's Revised Taxonomy, sequenced from foundational to complex. Content was organized using a spiraling curriculum design, where core skills are revisited and deepened across units. Appropriate instructional strategies, modalities, and assessment types were matched to each outcome.
3. **Development:** Session plans, activity materials, assessment tools, and teacher guidance notes were developed in alignment with the design specifications. All materials account for the multimodal and low-tech-first philosophy of the program.
4. **Implementation:** Teacher notes in each unit guide educators on pacing, language scaffolding, classroom management for young learners, and how to embed informal assessment into daily practice.
5. **Evaluation:** A Kirkpatrick Four-Level Evaluation plan (see Section 10) tracks learner reaction, learning gains, behavioral transfer, and long-term outcomes to enable ongoing program improvement.

1.2.2 Bloom's Revised Taxonomy (Three Domains)

All learning objectives in this program are written and categorized using the Revised Bloom's Taxonomy (Anderson & Krathwohl, 2001) across the three domains:

- **Cognitive Domain:** For ages 5–8, the primary operative levels are Remember (recall letter sounds, sight words), Understand (comprehend simple texts, retell stories), and Apply (use phonics knowledge to decode new words, use sight words in context). Higher-order levels — Analyze (identify story elements, notice word patterns), Evaluate (make predictions, express reading preferences), and

Create (dictate or illustrate original story responses) — are embedded as scaffolded extension tasks throughout Units 5 and 6.

- **Affective Domain:** Building positive attitudes toward reading in a foreign language is critical for long-term EFL reading success. The program explicitly targets Receiving (showing interest in English books), Responding (willingly participating in reading activities), and Valuing (choosing to engage with English texts independently).
- **Psychomotor Domain:** Developmentally relevant physical literacy skills are woven throughout: correct book handling and page turning, tracking print with a finger, left-to-right directionality, and early mark-making for letter formation.

1.2.3 Universal Design for Learning (UDL)

The CAST UDL Framework (Meyer, Rose & Gordon, 2014) ensures this program is designed for the full range of learners from the outset, rather than as a retrofitted accommodation:

- **Multiple Means of Representation:** All content is introduced visually (flashcards, picture books, illustrated word walls, realia), auditorily (phonics chants, songs, teacher read-alouds, oral storytelling), and kinesthetically (manipulatives, letter tiles, body phonics, games). No session relies on a single modality.
- **Multiple Means of Action & Expression:** Learners may respond by pointing, drawing, speaking, moving, sorting, matching, or writing. No session demands a single response format. Young learners who are not yet writing can participate fully through oral and physical responses.
- **Multiple Means of Engagement:** Activities include individual, partner, small-group, and whole-class formats. Intrinsic motivation is built through choice tasks, game-based learning, storytelling, and authentic communicative purpose for reading.

1.2.4 Constructivism & Sociocultural Theory (Vygotsky)

The Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD) is central to every session's scaffolding logic. Activities are pitched slightly above current independent ability, with structured teacher support that is gradually reduced across units. The teacher acts as the More Knowledgeable Other (MKO), but so do more advanced peers during partner and group work. Collaborative meaning-making is valued as a legitimate and powerful learning process in this program.

1.2.5 Science of Reading / Structured Literacy

The program aligns firmly with the current research consensus on early reading instruction, often referred to as the Science of Reading:

- Explicit, systematic phonological awareness instruction precedes phonics instruction (Units 1–2 before Unit 3)
- Systematic synthetic phonics instruction follows a carefully sequenced scope, introducing letter-sound correspondences in a logical, cumulative order
- Decodable texts — aligned to the phonics patterns and sight words taught — are used for reading practice throughout Units 3–6
- The Simple View of Reading (Gough & Tunmer, 1986) underpins the program design: Reading Comprehension = Decoding × Language Comprehension. Both pillars are developed in parallel throughout the program.

1.2.6 Multiple Intelligences (Gardner, 1983)

Activities across all six units are intentionally designed to engage Howard Gardner's eight intelligence types, ensuring all learners find meaningful access points regardless of their dominant learning strength:

- Linguistic: read-alouds, storytelling, word play, phonics chants
- Logical-Mathematical: phoneme counting, pattern recognition in word families, syllable sorting
- Spatial: picture books, illustrated story maps, flashcard matching, color-coded word walls

- Musical/Rhythmic: alphabet songs, phonics songs, rhyming games, reader's chants
- Bodily-Kinesthetic: body phonics, TPR activities, hopscotch sight words, letter sand trays
- Interpersonal: partner reading, group storytelling, cooperative games, reader's theater
- Intrapersonal: independent reading choices, reading response journals, self-assessment
- Naturalist: connecting environmental print to real-world objects and nature themes

1.2.7 Total Physical Response (TPR) & Play-Based Learning

Given the developmental stage of the target age group, TPR (Asher, 1969) and play-based instruction are not supplementary — they are foundational. Reading is embedded in physical action, movement games, dramatic play, storytelling performances, and creative activities. Learners learn to read by reading in contexts that matter to them: playing, singing, creating, and sharing.

1.3 Modern Approaches to Teaching EFL Reading

This program draws from eight distinct research-informed approaches to early EFL reading instruction. None is used in isolation; rather, they are woven together to create a cohesive instructional fabric:

6. **Structured Literacy (Science of Reading):** Explicit instruction in phonological awareness, phonics, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension. Systematic, sequential, and diagnostic-prescriptive.
7. **Balanced Literacy (selectively applied):** Shared reading models fluent reading and comprehension strategies. Guided reading differentiates instruction by level. Independent reading builds confidence and stamina. Applied with a structured literacy foundation, not as a replacement for explicit phonics instruction.
8. **Whole Language (meaning-first elements):** Authentic picture books and meaningful texts are used from Day 1. Reading always serves a communicative purpose. Environmental print and culturally relevant contexts are embedded throughout.
9. **Communicative Language Teaching (CLT):** Reading is embedded in authentic communication tasks: reading to share, discuss, perform, and respond. Meaning negotiation and purposeful interaction are prioritized alongside decoding accuracy.
10. **Multimodal Learning:** Every session integrates at least three modalities. Digital read-alouds, projected texts, interactive apps, and physical manipulatives are used alongside traditional print materials.
11. **Storytelling & Narrative Approach:** Story-based units build vocabulary, background knowledge, and comprehension simultaneously. Repetitive, predictable texts allow learners to approximate reading before full decoding is established, building fluency and confidence.
12. **Songs, Chants & Rhymes:** Phonological awareness — the oral and auditory foundation of reading — is built primarily through musical activities. Alphabet songs, phonics chants, nursery rhymes, and fingerplays make sound patterns memorable and fun.
13. **Digital Integration:** Optional digital enhancements include e-book read-alouds, phonics apps (e.g., Jolly Phonics, Starfall, Teach Your Monster to Read), and interactive whiteboard activities for whole-class phonics instruction.

1.4 Learner Development Overview

The 5–8 age range spans two critical developmental periods, each with distinct implications for reading instruction:

Ages 5–6: Early Childhood Stage

- Cognitive: Preoperational stage (Piaget); learning through play, imitation, and concrete experience; magical thinking; beginning symbolic representation
- Attention span: 15–25 minutes of focused engagement; requires frequent activity rotation (every 10–15 minutes)
- Language: Rapid vocabulary growth; enjoys rhyme, rhythm, and repetition; beginning to understand narrative structure
- Social: Parallel and cooperative play; responds to praise and positive reinforcement; strong relationship with teacher
- Literacy: May be pre-literate in L1 as well; print awareness may be developing; benefits most from shared/interactive reading and songs

Ages 7–8: Early Concrete Operational Stage

- Cognitive: Concrete operational stage; increasingly logical thinking; can categorize, sequence, and notice patterns
- Attention span: 25–40 minutes of focused engagement; greater capacity for structured instruction
- Language: More complex sentence structures; developing metalinguistic awareness; can discuss language explicitly
- Social: Cooperative learning; peer comparison; growing independent motivation; benefits from goal-setting and self-monitoring
- Literacy: May already be reading in L1 (transfers phonological awareness skills, though script differences apply); benefits from explicit phonics + meaningful texts

Implication for Design: Sessions are structured with 3–4 rotating activity types lasting 10–15 minutes each, ensuring both age groups remain engaged throughout a 60-minute session. Activities for ages 5–6 are more movement-based and song-driven; activities for ages 7–8 incorporate more explicit skill instruction and peer collaboration.

Section 2: Needs Analysis (ADDIE — Phase 1)

2.1 Learner Profile

- Age Range: 5 to 8 years old (mixed-age group possible; single-age groups preferred)
- Language Background: Non-English-speaking households; EFL context (English not used outside classroom)
- L1 Literacy Status: Variable. Learners ages 7–8 may already read in Arabic, French, or another L1. Learners ages 5–6 are typically pre-literate in all languages. Note: L1 literacy accelerates L2 phonological awareness transfer but does not replace the need for explicit English phonics instruction.
- Prior English Exposure: Variable — ranges from zero (no prior instruction) to limited (cartoons, songs, early childhood programs). No assumption of oral English proficiency is made at program entry.
- Cognitive Stage: Preoperational to early Concrete Operational (Piaget). Learning is concrete, social, and experiential.
- Motivators: Play, songs, stories, colorful visuals, physical activity, social interaction, praise, and tangible reward systems.
- Attention Span: 15–25 minutes (ages 5–6); 25–40 minutes (ages 7–8). Multiple short activity rotations are required.

2.2 Context Analysis

- Delivery Mode: Face-to-face classroom (primary); digital tools as optional enhancement
- Setting: Private language academy or school with access to basic classroom materials
- Recommended Class Size: 8–15 learners for optimal teacher-to-learner interaction
- Teacher Profile: EFL-trained teacher; ideally with some early childhood education background. Teacher notes are embedded in each unit to support instructors with limited YL experience.
- Materials Philosophy: Low-tech first (picture books, flashcards, realia, letter tiles, manipulatives); digital tools optional but integrated as extension opportunities
- Assessment Philosophy: Portfolio-based, observational, low-stakes, and celebratory in nature

2.3 Instructional Gap Analysis

Competency Area	Entry State (Program Start)	Exit State (Program End)
Print Awareness	Little to no awareness of books, print direction, or text conventions	Identifies cover, title, author; demonstrates left-to-right, top-to-bottom tracking; understands word/letter/sentence
Phonological Awareness	Limited or no conscious awareness of sounds in English words	Identifies and produces rhymes; segments syllables; isolates, blends, and segments phonemes in CVC words
Phonics Knowledge	No knowledge of English letter-sound correspondences	Produces sound for all 26 letters; decodes CVC words; reads simple decodable sentences using known patterns

Competency Area	Entry State (Program Start)	Exit State (Program End)
Sight Word Recognition	No high-frequency words recognized by sight	Instantly recognizes 30–40 high-frequency Dolch Pre-Primer and Primer words in isolation and in context
Reading Fluency	No fluency in English; no experience with connected text reading	Reads simple sentences and short decodable texts with basic phrasing, accuracy, and appropriate expression
Reading Comprehension	No comprehension strategy knowledge in English	Answers who/what/where questions; retells a simple story in sequence; makes basic predictions and connections
Reading Attitude	Neutral or uncertain relationship with English books	Demonstrates positive, confident, and enthusiastic engagement with English reading materials

2.4 Stakeholder Needs

- **Learners:** Need a joyful, low-stakes environment where early attempts at reading are celebrated. Require a clear sense of progress and achievement.
- **Teachers:** Need a structured but flexible program with clear session plans, embedded formative assessment, and guidance for differentiation.
- **Families:** Need visibility into their child's progress and practical ways to support home engagement with English reading (suggested home activities provided in each unit).
- **Institutions:** Need a program with measurable outcomes, a coherent scope and sequence, and materials that justify program investment.

Section 3: Program Goals & Learning Outcomes

3.1 Program Goal

By the end of this 46-hour program, young EFL learners (ages 5–8) will demonstrate the foundational skills necessary to decode and comprehend simple English texts independently, while developing a sustained positive attitude toward reading in English as a foreign language.

3.2 Exit Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of all six units, learners will be able to:

14. Demonstrate understanding of basic print concepts: book orientation, directionality, word/letter/sentence distinction, and the roles of author and illustrator.
15. Identify rhyming word pairs, produce rhyming words, segment spoken words into syllables, and isolate, blend, and segment individual phonemes in CVC words.
16. Produce the correct sound for each of the 26 letters of the English alphabet in isolation, and identify the letter for a given sound.
17. Blend onset and rime and decode CVC words with short vowels; read simple decodable sentences composed of known phonics patterns.
18. Recognize 30–40 high-frequency (sight) words by sight, both in isolation and embedded in simple sentences and short texts.
19. Read aloud simple decodable texts with basic fluency: appropriate pacing, accuracy, and beginning expressive prosody.
20. Answer simple literal comprehension questions (who, what, where) about a story read aloud or read independently.
21. Retell a simple story in beginning-middle-end sequence using key vocabulary, visual supports (story map, sequencing cards), or illustrations.
22. Express enjoyment, confidence, and interest when engaging with English reading materials in the classroom and at home.

3.3 Bloom's Taxonomy Alignment Table

Outcome #	Bloom's Domain	Cognitive Level	Affective Level	Unit(s)
1	Cognitive + Psychomotor	Remember / Understand	Receiving	Unit 1
2	Cognitive + Psychomotor	Remember / Apply	Responding	Unit 2
3	Cognitive	Remember / Apply	—	Unit 3
4	Cognitive	Apply	—	Unit 3

Outcome #	Bloom's Domain	Cognitive Level	Affective Level	Unit(s)
5	Cognitive	Remember / Apply	Responding	Unit 4
6	Cognitive + Psychomotor	Apply / Analyze	—	Unit 5
7	Cognitive	Understand / Analyze	Responding	Unit 6
8	Cognitive	Understand / Analyze	Responding	Unit 6
9	Affective	Create (Cognitive)	Valuing / Organizing	All Units

Section 4: Scope & Sequence and Curriculum Map

4.1 Program Overview

Unit	Title	Hours	Sessions	Core Focus	Key Skills	Assessment
1	Print Awareness & Pre-Reading Foundations	6	6	Books, directionality, print concepts	Tracking, book parts, environmental print	Print awareness checklist
2	Phonological & Phonemic Awareness	8	8	Sound play, rhyme, syllables, phonemes	Rhyming, segmenting, blending, isolating	Phonemic awareness screener
3	Systematic Phonics	12	12	Letter-sound correspondence s, CVC decoding	26 letter sounds, CVC blending, word families	Letter sound quiz + CVC reading task
4	Sight Words & HFW	6	6	High-frequency word recognition	30–40 Dolch pre-primer & primer words	Sight word flash assessment
5	Reading Fluency	8	8	Connected text reading with pacing & expression	Echo, choral, partner reading; Reader's Theater	Fluency rating rubric
6	Reading Comprehension	6	6	Story understanding, retelling, strategy use	Predicting, visualizing, retelling, connecting	Story response task + portfolio

4.2 Suggested Delivery Schedule

The 46 hours can be flexibly distributed based on your institutional calendar. Two recommended scheduling models are:

Model	Sessions per Week	Session Length	Total Weeks	Ideal For
Model A – Intensive	3 sessions/week	60 minutes each	~16 weeks (1 term)	Academy intensive programs, summer reading courses
Model B – Standard	2 sessions/week	60 minutes each	23 weeks (~1 academic year)	School-year integration, once-weekly class + homework extension

Model	Sessions per Week	Session Length	Total Weeks	Ideal For
Model C – Condensed	5 sessions/week	60 minutes each	~10 weeks	Full-day language camps, immersive holiday programs

For learners ages 5–6: Consider shortening individual sessions to 45 minutes and adding a 15-minute play-based consolidation activity. Total program time remains 46 hours.

4.3 Curriculum Design Principles

- **Spiraling Sequence:** Each unit explicitly connects to and builds upon the previous one. Phonological awareness (Unit 2) directly supports phonics learning (Unit 3); phonics enables sight word integration (Unit 4); decoding and sight words power fluency (Unit 5); fluency enables comprehension (Unit 6).
- **Cumulative Review:** Every session includes a 10-minute review of previously taught content. No skill is taught once and abandoned; all prior learning is continuously activated.
- **Authentic Purpose:** Every decoding skill is connected to real reading purposes. Learners decode to understand, to tell stories, to play, and to communicate — not as an end in itself.
- **Joyful Progress:** Progress is visible, celebrated, and learner-owned. Students track their own growth through personal reading logs, phonics passports, and sight word stamps.

Section 5: Detailed Unit Syllabi

Unit 1: Print Awareness & Pre-Reading Foundations (6 Hours | 6 Sessions)

This unit builds the earliest reading foundation: understanding what books are, how they work, and that print carries meaning. Learners develop a relationship with books and build the conceptual knowledge that underpins all future reading instruction. Delivered through shared reading, environmental exploration, and hands-on book interactions.

Unit 1 Learning Outcomes

- Identify the parts of a book (cover, title, author, illustrator, spine, pages)
- Demonstrate left-to-right, top-to-bottom print directionality with a pointer or finger
- Distinguish between a letter, a word, and a sentence in a simple text
- Recognize that print in the environment (signs, labels, packaging) carries meaning
- Follow along during a shared read-aloud and participate in prediction activities

Key Vocabulary & Concepts

title, author, illustrator, cover, word, letter, sentence, page, print, left, right, read, book, picture, story

Session Overview

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
1.1	Welcome to Books!	60 min	Remember, Receive	Identify cover, title, author; understand books tell stories	Book exploration center; shared read-aloud; labeling activity (cover parts)	Can student point to title, author, cover?
1.2	How We Read	60 min	Remember, Understand	Demonstrate directionality; understand the concept of a word	"Sweep reading" with pointer; left-right sorting game; tracking practice with Big Book	Observation: correct directional tracking
1.3	Letters and Words	60 min	Remember, Understand	Distinguish letters from words from sentences; count words in a sentence	Letter vs. word card sort; sentence clapping (one clap per word); pocket chart activities	Letter/word sorting task (8/10 correct)
1.4	Print All Around Us	60 min	Remember, Understand	Recognize environmental print; understand print carries real-world meaning	Environmental print walk (classroom labels); label-making station; logo/package print	Identifies 3+ real-world print examples correctly

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
					hunt	
1.5	Shared Reading Adventure	60 min	Understand, Apply	Participate in shared reading; make picture-based predictions; track text	Picture walk and prediction chart; Big Book shared reading with class involvement	Participation + prediction attempt (observation)
1.6	My Book About Me (Review)	60 min	Apply, Create	Review all print concepts; demonstrate understanding through personal mini-book creation	"I Spy" print review game; personal mini-book creation; sharing circle	Print awareness checklist (6 concepts observed)

Unit 1 Assessment: Teacher uses the Print Awareness Checklist (see Section 7) to assess each learner individually. Minimum mastery: 5/6 print concepts. Learners who do not demonstrate mastery receive targeted re-teaching before Unit 2 begins.

Unit 2: Phonological & Phonemic Awareness (8 Hours | 8 Sessions)

This unit develops the critical oral and auditory foundation for all phonics learning. Learners discover that spoken words are made of sounds, that sounds can be manipulated, and that language patterns — especially rhyme and rhythm — are playful and pleasurable. No print is required; all activities are listening and speaking. Unit 2 is designed to be joyful, song-rich, and deeply accessible before any letter-sound instruction begins.

Unit 2 Learning Outcomes

- Identify and produce rhyming word pairs in English
- Segment spoken words into syllables and count syllables accurately
- Isolate the initial phoneme in a spoken CVC word
- Isolate the final phoneme in a spoken CVC word
- Blend 3–4 phonemes orally to form a CVC word
- Segment a CVC word into its individual phonemes and count them

Key Vocabulary & Concepts

rhyme, syllable, sound, word, beginning sound, ending sound, blend, segment, clap, tap

Session Overview

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
2.1	Rhyme Time! – Recognition	60 min	Remember	Identify rhyming pairs; discriminate rhyme from non-rhyme	Nursery rhyme read-aloud; Rhyme Sorting game (cat/hat vs. cat/dog); thumbs up/down rhyme check	Correctly identifies 8/10 rhyme pairs
2.2	Let's Rhyme! – Production	60 min	Remember, Apply	Produce rhyming words orally; extend rhyme chains	Rhyme chain circle game; puppet rhyme show; "Can you rhyme it?" partner challenge	Produces 2+ rhymes for each given word (5 target words)
2.3	Clap & Count Syllables	60 min	Remember, Understand	Segment words into syllables; count syllables accurately	Name clapping; animal syllable sort (1/2/3 syllables); drum/tap-the-syllable activity	Segments 8/10 words into correct syllable count
2.4	Syllable Blending	60 min	Understand, Apply	Blend syllables to form whole words; identify compound word components	"What's my word?" blending game; compound picture cards (sun+flower); robot talk syllables	Correctly blends 6/8 syllable prompts
2.5	First Sounds – Initial Phonemes	60 min	Remember, Understand	Isolate and identify the first phoneme in spoken CVC words	"I Spy with my ear" game; alliteration tongue twisters; initial sound sorting cards	Correctly identifies initial phoneme in 8/10 words
2.6	Last Sounds – Final Phonemes	60 min	Remember, Understand	Isolate and identify the final phoneme in spoken CVC words	End-sound sorting cards; "Robot talk" final sounds; rhyme-final-sound connection activity	Correctly identifies final phoneme in 7/10 words
2.7	Blending Phonemes	60 min	Apply	Orally blend 3 phonemes into a CVC word	Elkonin boxes with counters (push-say-blend); phoneme chain game; "Guess my word" teacher demo	Correctly blends 8/10 phoneme sequences
2.8	Segmenting Phonemes	60 min	Apply	Segment CVC words into individual phonemes; count	Elkonin boxes with chips; body segmenting (touch shoulder/elbow/wrist per phoneme);	Segments 7/10 CVC words correctly into 3 phonemes

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
				phonemes	"How many sounds?" quiz	

Unit 2 Assessment: End-of-unit Phonemic Awareness Screener (oral, teacher-administered). Targets: rhyme identification, syllable segmentation, initial/final phoneme isolation, phoneme blending, phoneme segmentation. Pass threshold: 75% accuracy across all five areas.

Unit 3: Systematic Phonics (12 Hours | 12 Sessions)

This is the program's most extensive unit, dedicating 12 hours to explicit, systematic synthetic phonics instruction. All 26 letter-sound correspondences are introduced in a carefully sequenced order, moving from most frequent and distinct to least frequent. The unit culminates in CVC word decoding, short vowel work, and word family reading — giving learners their first experience of truly independent reading in English.

Unit 3 Learning Outcomes

- Produce the correct phoneme for each of the 26 letters of the English alphabet
- Identify the corresponding letter when a phoneme is spoken
- Blend C-V-C phonemes to read simple three-letter words
- Segment CVC words into letters and identify each sound
- Identify and read words from at least six common word families

Key Vocabulary & Concepts

All 26 letter names and sounds; short vowels /a/, /e/, /i/, /o/, /u/; CVC words; word families: -at, -an, -it, -in, -og, -un; blend, decode, sound, letter, vowel, consonant

Session Overview

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
3.1	Aa, Bb, Cc	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /æ/, /b/, /k/; recognize letters in words	Letter formation (air writing, sand tray); picture-sound matching; chant "A is for apple..."	Produces correct sound for 3 letters with 90% accuracy
3.2	Dd, Ee, Ff	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /d/, /ɛ/ (short), /f/; trace and identify letters	Phonics flashcard drill; beginning sound sorting; letter detective in Big Book	Letter-sound card recognition test
3.3	Gg, Hh, Ii	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /g/ (hard), /h/, /ɪ/	Phonics BINGO; picture-letter match; letter hunt	Observation during BINGO + letter-sound

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
				(short i)	in classroom environment	matching card
3.4	Jj, Kk, Ll	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /dʒ/, /k/, /l/; form letters correctly	Gross motor letter writing (floor/whiteboard); phonics card memory game; letter action game	Writes and says sound for Jj, Kk, Ll on exit slip
3.5	Mm, Nn, Oo	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /m/, /n/, /ɒ/ (short o)	Playdough letter formation; beginning/final sound sorting; phonics relay race	Letter-sound oral quiz (6 letters reviewed)
3.6	Pp, Qq, Rr	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /p/, /kw/, /r/; recognize letters in decodable words	Phonics battle cards; sound search in classroom; chant: "P-Q-R, what do you say?"	Points to correct letter when sound is spoken (12 letters cumulative)
3.7	Ss, Tt, Uu	60 min	Remember	Produce sounds /s/, /t/, /ʌ/ (short u); distinguish vowels from consonants	Letter-sound Snap game; vowel vs. consonant sorting; phonics writing practice	Letter-sound written quiz (S, T, U + 5 review letters)
3.8	Vv, Ww, Xx, Yy, Zz	60 min	Remember	Produce remaining 5 letter sounds; complete full alphabet knowledge	Alphabet completion song; phonics memory game (all 26); celebration ABC chart	Alphabet letter-sound checklist (all 26 letters assessed)
3.9	Short Vowels – Heart of Words	60 min	Remember, Understand	Identify short vowel sounds in CVC words; distinguish 5 short vowel sounds	Short vowel chant ("A says /æ/..."); vowel CVC picture sort; vowel identification in spoken words	Correctly identifies vowel sound in 10/15 CVC words
3.10	CVC Blending Practice	60 min	Apply	Blend C+V+C phonemes to read CVC words; use Elkonin boxes with letters	Word building with letter tiles; word ladders (cat→bat→bag); decodable sentence reading	Reads 15/20 CVC flashcard words accurately
3.11	Word	60 min	Apply	Read and produce words	Word family flip books; family	Reads 3+ words from each of 5

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
	Families			in -at, -an, -it, -in, -og, -un families	sorting race; "grow a family" word building on whiteboard	word families (15+ total)
3.12	Phonics Review & Word Building	60 min	Apply, Analyze	Apply all phonics knowledge; build and read CVC words independently	4-station phonics center rotation; personal phonics dictionary creation; decodable book reading	End-of-unit phonics checklist: all 26 sounds + CVC reading (see Section 7)

Unit 3 Assessment: Two-part assessment: (1) Letter-Sound Checklist: teacher shows each letter card; learner produces the sound. Mastery: 24/26 correct. (2) CVC Reading Task: learner reads 20 CVC word cards. Mastery: 15/20 correct. Learners below mastery threshold receive targeted phonics support before Unit 4 begins.

Unit 4: Sight Words & High-Frequency Words (6 Hours | 6 Sessions)

This unit introduces 30–40 of the most common English words that learners will encounter in virtually every simple text. Because many of these words are phonetically irregular or appear before their phonics patterns have been taught, they are learned as whole-word units through repeated, multisensory exposure. Sight word mastery dramatically increases reading fluency and comprehension, freeing up cognitive resources for decoding unfamiliar words.

Unit 4 Learning Outcomes

- Recognize 30–40 Dolch Pre-Primer and Primer high-frequency words instantly by sight
- Read sight words accurately when encountered within simple sentences
- Use known sight words to support independent reading of simple decodable texts

Key Vocabulary & Concepts

Dolch Pre-Primer: the, a, I, is, it, and, in, on, we, to, can, see, go, me, my, he, she, they, you, are, like, look, here, said, have, big, little, up, come, this (30 words total)

Session Overview

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
4.1	Sight Words Set 1: the, a, I, is, it	60 min	Remember	Recognize and name 5 target words; introduce word wall	Flashcard introduction; trace-copy-recall; word wall addition;	Reads 5 target words from cards individually

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
					"I am a reader" sentence frame	
4.2	Sight Words Set 2: and, in, on, we, to	60 min	Remember, Apply	Recognize Set 2 words; use in simple sentence frames; review Set 1	Sight word BINGO (Sets 1+2); sentence building with word cards; "We can see..." frames	Reads Sets 1+2 (10 words) from shuffled cards → 8/10 correct
4.3	Sight Words Set 3: can, see, go, me, my	60 min	Remember, Apply	Recognize Set 3 words; read in context sentences; cumulative review	Sight word hopscotch; "I can see a..." sentence strips; reading from simple emergent reader	Cumulative flashcard check (15 words) → 12/15 correct
4.4	Sight Words Set 4: he, she, they, you, are	60 min	Remember, Apply	Recognize Set 4 pronouns/verbs; use in sentence completion	Sight word memory pairs; interactive sentence building; pronoun sorting with pictures	Reads Sets 1–4 (20 words) → 16/20 correct
4.5	Sight Words Set 5: like, look, here, said, have	60 min	Remember, Apply	Recognize Set 5; read sight words in simple story text	Word wall update; partner reading with sight words; write-the-room sight word hunt	End-of-set assessment: 25 words → 20/25 correct
4.6	Sight Words Set 6 + Reading in Context	60 min	Apply	Recognize final 5 words (big, little, up, come, this); read simple books with high sight word content	Final set introduction; decodable reader with 25+ sight words; word wall celebration review	Sight Word Mastery Assessment: 30+ words → 24/30 correct (see Section 7)

Unit 4 Assessment: Sight Word Mastery Assessment: Teacher presents all 30 words on flashcards in random order. Learner reads each card. Mastery: 24/30 (80%) correct with

automatic, instant recognition (no sounding out). Words not mastered are flagged for continued review in Units 5 and 6.

Unit 5: Reading Fluency (8 Hours | 8 Sessions)

Once learners can decode simple CVC words and recognize key sight words, the focus shifts to reading connected text with increasing fluency. This unit uses five evidence-based fluency instructional methods: echo reading, choral reading, partner reading, repeated reading, and Reader's Theater. The unit frames fluency not as speed, but as meaning-driven oral reading — reading that sounds like natural speech.

Unit 5 Learning Outcomes

- Define fluency as reading with accuracy, appropriate pace, and expression
- Demonstrate echo reading with matched rate and tone
- Participate in choral reading of a shared text with appropriate phrasing
- Sustain partner reading of a simple decodable text with peer support
- Perform a short Reader's Theater script with character-appropriate expression

Key Vocabulary & Concepts

fluency, expression, pace, accuracy, phrase, punctuation, period, question mark, exclamation mark, partner, echo, choral, theater, character

Session Overview

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
5.1	What Is Fluent Reading?	60 min	Remember, Understand	Define fluency; compare fluent vs. disfluent reading samples; identify qualities of fluent reading	Listen and compare (two read-aloud versions); fluency anchor chart; fluency vocabulary introduction	Can identify 3 qualities of fluent reading (discussion)
5.2	Echo Reading	60 min	Understand, Apply	Echo teacher's phrasing, pace, and expression accurately	Echo reading with simple predictable book; teacher models; learners echo phrase by phrase	Observation: pace matching, expression attempt
5.3	Choral Reading	60 min	Apply	Read simultaneously with group; match phrasing to teacher's model	Choral reading of projected poem/chant; Big Book choral reading; add	Group participation observation; individual check (2–3 learners per session)

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
					hand gestures for expression	
5.4	Partner Reading	60 min	Apply	Read alternating sentences/pages with a partner; provide kind error feedback	Partner reading protocol introduction; paired reading of simple decodable reader; sentence-swap format	Partner reading observation checklist
5.5	Repeated Reading	60 min	Apply, Evaluate	Read the same short text 3 times with growing fluency; notice self-improvement	3-pass repeated reading with simple tracking sheet; learners chart how reading felt each time	Self-rating: "How did that feel?" (smiley face scale); teacher notes errors
5.6	Prosody – Reading with Feeling!	60 min	Apply, Analyze	Use punctuation cues to vary expression (period=calm, ?=curious, !=excited)	Punctuation station sorting; "Read it three ways" cards; expressive read-aloud with audience response	Reads 5 sentences with appropriate punctuation-driven expression
5.7	Reader's Theater	60 min	Apply, Create	Perform a simple script with character voices; rehearse for expression and accuracy	Script distribution; character assignment; 2 rehearsal rounds; performance for class	Reader's Theater participation rubric (3-point scale: expression, volume, accuracy)
5.8	Fluency Portfolio & Celebration	60 min	Apply, Evaluate	Demonstrate fluent reading of a self-selected simple text; celebrate reading progress	Optional recording of reading on device; fluency self-assessment; reading progress share	Fluency Rating Rubric (see Section 7); portfolio entry added

Unit 5 Assessment: Fluency Rating Rubric applied during Sessions 5.7 and 5.8. Three dimensions: Accuracy (words read correctly), Pace (appropriate rate for age/level), Expression (evidence of prosody and phrasing). 3-point scale per dimension. Portfolio includes at least one recorded or teacher-noted reading sample.

Unit 6: Reading Comprehension & Story Response (6 Hours | 6 Sessions)

The final unit brings all prior learning together in service of the ultimate goal: understanding what is read. Comprehension strategies are introduced through teacher read-alouds and shared reading, making them accessible even to learners whose independent decoding is still emerging. Learners engage before, during, and after reading using age-appropriate graphic organizers, story maps, drawing, and discussion.

Unit 6 Learning Outcomes

- Use picture-based previewing and prediction before reading a new text
- Ask and answer who, what, and where questions about a story during and after reading
- Retell a simple story in beginning-middle-end order using a visual story map
- Make a personal connection to a text using the "This reminds me of..." frame
- Identify story elements: character, setting, and problem in a simple story

Key Vocabulary & Concepts

predict, visualize, retell, question, connect, character, setting, problem, solution, beginning, middle, end, who, what, where, story map, plot

Session Overview

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
6.1	Before We Read: Predicting & Previewing	60 min	Understand, Analyze	Conduct a picture walk; make predictions; activate prior knowledge	Picture walk with "I think..." sentence stems; prediction T-chart (prediction/evidence); teacher think-aloud	Makes at least 1 evidence-based prediction orally or by drawing
6.2	While We Read: Visualizing & Questioning	60 min	Understand, Analyze	Visualize during read-aloud; generate who/what/where questions spontaneously	Stop-and-visualize with drawing response; "Wonder Wall" question posting; teacher think-aloud	Draws or describes a visualized scene; asks or answers 1 literal question
6.3	After We Read: Retelling Stories	60 min	Understand, Apply	Retell a story in B-M-E sequence using story map or sequencing cards	Story map graphic organizer; sequencing card ordering; partner oral retell; story stones	Retells with 3 correct B-M-E elements (oral + illustrated)

#	Session Title	Duration	Bloom's Level	Core Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment
6.4	Making Connections: Text-to-Self	60 min	Understand, Apply	Make personal connections to a story using T-T-S frame; share connections respectfully	"This reminds me of..." anchor chart; connection drawing with sentence frame; partner sharing circle	Makes 1 genuine text-to-self connection with explanation
6.5	Story Elements: Character, Setting, Problem	60 min	Analyze	Identify character, setting, and problem in a simple story; use graphic organizer	Story elements anchor chart; "Who-Where-What-Problem" organizer; matching activity with multiple stories	Identifies all 3 story elements for a teacher-read story
6.6	Little Readers Celebration!	60 min	Apply, Create, Evaluate	Demonstrate comprehension of a listened-to story; share reading journey; celebrate achievement	Final comprehension task (story + 3 drawing-based response questions); certificate ceremony; "I can read!" book sharing	Final comprehension task + Portfolio reviewed; Certificate of Completion awarded

Unit 6 Assessment: Final Comprehension Task: Teacher reads a new, unfamiliar short story (approximately 150–200 words with illustrations). Learners respond to 3 questions using a drawing + labeling format: (1) Who is the story about? (2) Where does the story happen? (3) What happens at the end? Plus: Draw your favourite part. Portfolio is reviewed as a whole for holistic end-of-program assessment.

Section 6: Sample Session Plans

Three complete session plans are provided below: one from the foundational stage (Unit 1), one from the phonics unit (Unit 3), and one from the fluency unit (Unit 5). These plans model the instructional structure, timing, and differentiation approach intended for all 46 sessions.

Sample Plan A — Session 1.1: "Welcome to Books!"

Unit 1: Print Awareness & Pre-Reading Foundations | Target Age: 5–8

Session Plan: 1.1 — Welcome to Books!	
Unit	Unit 1: Print Awareness & Pre-Reading Foundations
Duration	60 minutes
Age Group	5–8 years old (differentiate for 5–6 vs. 7–8)
Bloom's Level	Cognitive: Remember, Understand Affective: Receiving, Responding Psychomotor: Tracking
Materials	– 5–6 different picture books (ideally with a range of covers) – Big Book: "Brown Bear, Brown Bear, What Do You See?" (Bill Martin Jr.) – Large pointer (ruler or craft stick) – "Parts of a Book" anchor chart (pre-made) – Sticky labels (title, author, illustrator, cover, pages) – Drawing materials for exit activity – Sticker reward stars

Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, learners will be able to:

1. Point to and name at least 3 parts of a book (cover, title, author)
2. Understand that a book is written by an author and illustrated by an illustrator
3. Demonstrate basic book-handling skills (holding upright, turning pages from front to back)
4. Make a simple prediction about a book based on the cover illustration

Session Flow

Timing	Activity Details
0:00–0:10	Warm-Up: "I Love Books!" Song (10 minutes) Purpose: Build excitement and positive association with books; establish routine opening Teacher Note: Use a simple, upbeat song to the tune of "If You're Happy and You Know It". Verses: "If you like to read a book, clap your hands!" / "If you want to learn to read, stomp your feet!" Project lyrics if available. Repeat twice. For 5–6 year-olds: add movement. For 7–8 year-olds: invite learners to make up extra verses.
0:10–0:22	Activity 1: Book Exploration Center (12 minutes) Purpose: Allow learners to explore books independently; build curiosity and a love of books Teacher Note: Place 5–6 different picture books on desks or a carpet center. Allow learners to browse freely. Prompt with open questions: "What do you notice?" / "What do you think this book is about?" / "Can you find the title?" Do NOT correct at this stage — this is pure exploration. Circulate and observe which learners can already locate the title, which ones hold books upside down, etc. This is your informal diagnostic.
0:22–0:35	Activity 2: "Parts of a Book" Anchor Chart (13 minutes) Purpose: Explicitly teach print concepts: cover, title, author, illustrator; build academic vocabulary Teacher Note: Hold up the Big Book. Point to each feature as you introduce it: "This is the cover — the front of the book." / "This is the title — the name of the book. Say it with me: title." Point slowly to each word as you say the title. Introduce author and illustrator. Stick labels on the anchor chart. Ask a learner to come and point to each part. Do this 3–4 times with volunteers. For ages 7–8: ask "Why do you think the author wrote this book?" to invite higher-order thinking.
0:35–0:50	Activity 3: Shared Read-Aloud (15 minutes) Purpose: Model fluent reading; demonstrate directionality; engage learners in prediction and response Teacher Note: Read "Brown Bear, Brown Bear" aloud with expression. Before reading: "Let's do a picture walk." Show each page without reading. Ask: "What do you see? What do you think will happen?" During reading: Run the pointer under the text slowly as you read. Pause on refrains and let learners complete them. The predictable, repetitive structure ensures ALL learners can participate. After reading: "Who wrote this book? Who drew the pictures?" Point back to the author/illustrator page. Praise: "You listened beautifully!"
0:50–0:60	Closure: "I Found It!" Labeling Game + Exit Ticket (10 minutes) Purpose: Consolidate learning; assess understanding; celebrate first session Teacher Note: Give each learner a simple drawing of a book (pre-drawn outline). Ask: "Can you draw or write the title on the cover? Who wrote it?" Learners label their book drawings. Circulate and note who can recall each concept. Award a sticker star to each learner as they exit. "Today you became book explorers! Next time, we will learn which way our eyes move when we read." Brief informal exit check: "Show me the front cover. Point to the title." Note 2–3 learners per session for tracking.

Differentiation

Strategy	Ages 5–6	Ages 7–8
Scaffolding	Use only 2 book features (cover + title); provide pre-labeled book outlines	Introduce all 5 features; add "spine" and "back cover"; encourage reading the blurb
Language Support	Use L1 to confirm comprehension of "author" and "illustrator" if needed	Encourage explanation of author/illustrator roles in their own words
Extension	Point to additional books and find title independently	Write a title for their own imaginary book on the exit ticket

Assessment Notes

Observation targets for this session (use Print Awareness Checklist — Section 7):

- Can the learner point to the front cover? (Concept 1)
- Can the learner find the title? (Concept 2)
- Does the learner hold the book correctly (right way up, front to front)? (Concept 3)
- Does the learner know what an author does? (Concept 4)

Home Connection

"Tonight, find a book at home (or a magazine, a cereal box, a street sign). Can you find the title? Take a picture to show us tomorrow!" Send a simple note home with the task in English and Arabic/French as relevant to your context.

Sample Plan B — Session 3.10: "CVC Words – Blending Practice"

Unit 3: Systematic Phonics | Target Age: 5–8

Session Plan: 3.10 — CVC Words – Blending Practice	
Unit	Unit 3: Systematic Phonics
Duration	60 minutes
Age Group	5–8 years old
Bloom's Level	Cognitive: Apply Previous Levels: Remember (sessions 3.1–3.9)
Materials	– Letter tiles or magnetic letters (full alphabet sets, 1 per pair) – Elkonin sound boxes (printed or drawn, 3 boxes per card) – Counters / cubes in 3 colors (C, V, C)

Session Plan: 3.10 — CVC Words – Blending Practice

- Word ladder strips: cat→bat→bag→big (laminated)
- Simple decodable sentence strips (CVC focus)
- "Word of the Day" star card
- Whiteboards and dry-erase markers (1 per learner)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, learners will be able to:

- Blend 3 phonemes C-V-C in sequence to decode a target word without teacher support
- Use Elkonin sound boxes to segment a CVC word and identify each phoneme
- Read 15+ CVC words from flashcards with 80% accuracy
- Read 3 simple decodable sentences containing CVC words and known sight words

Session Flow

Timing	Activity Details
0:00–0:10	Warm-Up: Alphabet Sound Review Chant (10 minutes) Purpose: Reactivate prior knowledge of all 26 letter sounds; energize learners Teacher Note: Use a call-and-response alphabet chant: Teacher holds up flashcard, learners call out sound. Move briskly — do not linger. Focus on letters that appeared most in last session's assessment errors. Invite individual learners to "be the teacher" and hold up a card. For 5–6: keep it song-like and playful. For 7–8: time the review like a quiz game ("Can we beat yesterday's score?").
0:10–0:25	Activity 1: Elkonin Box Sound Segmenting (15 minutes) Purpose: Build the phoneme-to-letter bridge; show each sound has a "home" in the word Teacher Note: Distribute Elkonin box cards and colored counters (3 colors: red for C, blue for V, red for C). Say a CVC word slowly. Learners push one counter into each box as they say each sound. Then: reveal the letters. "The /k/ sound lives here. What letter says /k/?" Build to: learners place letter tiles in boxes instead of counters. Words: sat, big, hop, run, bed, cup, fit, log, pan, mud. Circulate. Watch for learners who push counters for syllables rather than phonemes — redirect with slow modeling.
0:25–0:38	Activity 2: Word Ladders (13 minutes) Purpose: Practice decoding in a dynamic, game-like context; notice how changing one letter changes the word Teacher Note: Distribute word ladder strips (cat→bat→bag→big→dig). Read each word together chorally. Ask: "What changed? Which sound is different?" Learners use whiteboards to write each new word. For extra challenge: create novel ladders on the whiteboard as a class: "We said 'cat'. If I change /k/ to /h/, what do I get?" Encourage learners to challenge each other: "You change one letter, I'll read it!"
0:38–0:52	Activity 3: Decodable Sentence Reading (14 minutes) Purpose: Transfer decoding skills to connected text; build reading confidence Teacher Note: Distribute 3–4 decodable sentence strips. Example sentences: "The cat sat on the mat." / "Can the big dog run?" / "I see a red hen." / "Put the bug in a bag." Learners read independently first, then check with a partner, then read aloud to teacher during circulating check. Count accurate words. Provide immediate positive corrective feedback: "Almost! Let me

Timing	Activity Details
	<i>hear that word slowly." Do NOT move on if a learner is stuck — model the blend and have them repeat.</i>
0:52–0:60	Closure: "Word of the Day" + Exit Cards (8 minutes) Purpose: Consolidate; celebrate; assess quickly Teacher Note: Choose one word from the lesson as "Word of the Day" — write it dramatically on the board. Learners copy it on their whiteboard, segment it in Elkonin boxes, and say the word to a partner. Exit card: Give each learner a small card with 3 CVC words to read aloud to teacher as they leave. Note results on assessment tracker (see Section 7). Stamp or sticker for all learners who participated fully.

Differentiation

Level	Approach	Examples
Below Grade Level	Reduce word set to 8 CVC words; pre-select words with very distinct short vowels; allow use of picture cues alongside word tiles	sat, big, hop (avoid minimal pairs like hat/hot initially)
On Grade Level	Full session as planned with 15–20 CVC words	Standard word ladder + sentence strips
Above Grade Level	Introduce CCVC words (trip, flat, stop) as extension after mastering CVC set; learner creates their own word ladder	flat→slat→slab→crab (CCVC ladder)

Assessment Notes

- Exit card data: count words read correctly per learner (target: 15/20 CVC word cards by Unit 3 end)
- Note: Which vowel sounds cause most errors? This informs Session 3.9 review if needed
- Record: Which learners needed significant support at Elkonin step? Flag for Unit 3.12 center differentiation

Sample Plan C — Session 5.7: "Reader's Theater"

Unit 5: Reading Fluency | Target Age: 5–8

Session Plan: 5.7 — Reader's Theater	
Unit	Unit 5: Reading Fluency
Duration	60 minutes

Session Plan: 5.7 — Reader's Theater

Age Group	6–8 years (best suited; 5-year-olds with simplified scripts)
Bloom's Level	Cognitive: Apply, Create Affective: Valuing Bloom's: Apply, Analyze, Create
Materials	– 4 simple Reader's Theater scripts (4–6 roles each; Lexile level ~100–200L, CVC + sight words only) – Role name badges or paper crowns – Highlighters (one color per role to mark their lines) – Performance space (chairs in circle or small stage area) – Optional: simple costume piece per character (hat, scarf, ears) – Applause card for audience (printed hand-clapping image) – Fluency rubric (simplified 3-point) – Recording device (optional — phone/tablet)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, learners will be able to:

27. Read their assigned script lines with appropriate character-matched expression
28. Use vocal variety (volume, pace, pitch) to convey meaning in a performance context
29. Support peers as an engaged, respectful audience member
30. Identify one thing they did well and one thing they want to improve in their fluency

Session Flow

Timing	Activity Details
0:00–0:08	Warm-Up: Voice Warm-Up Exercises (8 minutes) Purpose: Prepare speaking voices; build energy and readiness for performance Teacher Note: Do a series of silly voice exercises: "Read this sentence in a TINY voice... now a GIANT voice... now a sleepy voice... now a surprised voice!" Use one simple sentence from last session's reading. This primes learners for expressive reading and creates a positive, playful atmosphere. Model first with exaggerated commitment — learners laugh and engage more when the teacher is clearly having fun.
0:08–0:18	Setup: Script Distribution & Role Assignment (10 minutes) Purpose: Orient learners to their scripts; ensure everyone understands their role Teacher Note: Distribute scripts. Read through the full script once at a normal pace as learners follow along. Then: assign roles by handing out name badges. Highlight each learner's lines in their script. For young readers: use a different color per role and say "Whenever you see BLUE, that is YOUR line." Do a slow second read-through where teacher supports any learner who cannot yet decode their lines — echo read with them first.
0:18–0:38	Rehearsal Round 1 and Round 2 (20 minutes) Purpose: Build accuracy and beginning expression through rehearsal; move from reading to performing Teacher Note: Round 1 (10 min): Sit in chairs, read scripts at table. Focus on accuracy first.

Timing	Activity Details
	<i>Teacher circulates and quietly supports. Round 2 (10 min): Stand up. Add body positions or simple gestures for their character. Read with more expression. Teacher gives brief feedback after Round 2: "I noticed Maya used a big voice for the lion — excellent!" Pair stronger and weaker readers in the same performance group where possible. Resist the urge to "fix" every error — fluency comes from confidence, not perfection.</i>
0:38–0:52	Performance (14 minutes) Purpose: Experience the joy of a real reading performance; build confidence and motivation Teacher Note: 2 groups perform for each other (10–12 min each, or all groups if time allows). Audience receives an applause card — they are active participants, not passive observers. After each performance: brief class comment round: "One word to describe how [Group] read?" Collect: "clear", "funny", "loud", "good" — all positive. Optional: record one group's performance on a tablet to share with families. After recording: watch back together and notice expression moments.
0:52–0:60	Reflection & Rubric (8 minutes) Purpose: Develop self-assessment skills; close with specific, positive acknowledgment Teacher Note: Simplified self-assessment: give each learner a card with 3 face choices (great / ok / need practice) next to 3 criteria: "I read MY lines" / "I used a character voice" / "I helped my team." Learners circle their self-rating. Share one with a partner. Teacher collects for portfolio. Close: "You just performed a real show in English. You are REAL readers." Award a "Little Readers Star" sticker/certificate for participating.

Sample Script Themes (Emergent Level)

- The Three Little Pigs (simplified): 5 roles: Narrator, Pig 1, Pig 2, Pig 3, Wolf
- The Enormous Turnip (adapted): 4 roles: Narrator, Farmer, Wife, Child + 3 Animal Helpers
- Going to the Zoo: 4 roles: Narrator, Child, Parent, Zookeeper (sight word heavy: we, see, go, look, big, little)
- The Lost Cat: 4 roles: Narrator, Girl, Boy, Cat (CVC word heavy: cat, sat, fat, mat, ran, can)

Assessment

Fluency Rating Rubric (3-point scale applied during performance):

Criterion	1 – Emerging	2 – Developing	3 – Proficient
Accuracy	Reads fewer than 70% of lines correctly	Reads 70–84% of lines correctly	Reads 85%+ of lines correctly with few/no errors
Pace	Very slow, word-by-word reading	Mostly smooth with some word-by-word phrasing	Smooth, phrase-level reading at natural rate
Expression	Monotone; no character differentiation	Some expression; beginning to vary voice	Clear character voice; uses volume/pitch/pace for meaning

Section 7: Assessment Framework

7.1 Assessment Philosophy

Assessment in LITTLE READERS is observation-first, portfolio-based, and developmentally celebratory. Young EFL learners in the 5–8 age range are not served by high-stakes testing. Instead, this program uses a continuous, embedded assessment model that gathers evidence of learning through observation, task completion, and performance, not through formal tests.

Core Principle: Assessment should tell us what a child can do, not what they cannot. All assessments in this program are designed to reveal competence, not failure. Every tool has a "celebration marker" alongside a growth marker.

7.2 Types of Assessment

Diagnostic Assessment (Program Entry)

- Purpose: Establish each learner's prior knowledge before instruction; differentiate instruction from Session 1
- When: First 15 minutes of Session 1.1 (observation during Book Exploration Center)
- Tools: Informal observation checklist; print awareness screening questions; phonological awareness oral probe (optional for ages 7–8)

Formative Assessment (Every Session)

- Purpose: Monitor learning in real time; adjust pacing and support immediately
- When: During every session, embedded in activities (not as separate assessment blocks)
- Tools: Teacher observation with anecdotal notes; exit cards (3-word read, 1-sentence response, drawing); thumbs up/middle/down self-check; partner check-ins; whiteboard quick-writes
- Teacher Action: If 3+ learners cannot demonstrate the session objective, re-teach with a different approach before moving on. Never proceed when the majority has not grasped the foundational skill.

Summative Assessment (End of Each Unit)

- Unit 1: Print Awareness Checklist (6 concepts, observation-based)
- Unit 2: Phonemic Awareness Screener (oral, teacher-administered, 5 skills)
- Unit 3: Letter-Sound Checklist (26 letters) + CVC Reading Task (20 words)
- Unit 4: Sight Word Mastery Assessment (30 words, individual flashcard reading)
- Unit 5: Fluency Rating Rubric (3 dimensions: accuracy, pace, expression)
- Unit 6: Final Comprehension Task + Portfolio Review

Portfolio Assessment (Program-Long)

- Each learner maintains a LITTLE READERS Portfolio: a folder, booklet, or envelope
- Contents include: Print awareness exit ticket, phonics letter-sound record, CVC word reading sample, sight word tracking chart, fluency self-rating cards, story response drawings, Reader's Theater self-assessment, final comprehension task, and "Celebration Certificate"
- Portfolios are shared with families at the end of the program
- Portfolio review at the end of Unit 6 serves as the holistic summative evaluation of the full program

7.3 Key Assessment Tools

Tool	Unit	Administered By	Format	Mastery Threshold
Print Awareness Checklist	1	Teacher (observation)	6-item checklist (point/name/demonstrate)	5/6 concepts demonstrated
Phonemic Awareness Screener	2	Teacher (oral, 1:1)	5 sub-skills, 10 items each	75% across all 5 areas
Alphabet Letter-Sound Checklist	3	Teacher (flashcards, 1:1)	26 letter cards; learner says sound	24/26 correct (92%)
CVC Word Reading Task	3	Teacher (flashcards, 1:1)	20 CVC word cards	15/20 correct (75%)
Sight Word Mastery Assessment	4	Teacher (flashcards, 1:1)	30 Dolch words; instant recognition	24/30 correct (80%)
Fluency Rating Rubric	5	Teacher (observation during performance)	3-dimension rubric, 1–3 scale	Score of 2+ on all 3 dimensions
Final Comprehension Task	6	Teacher (listen + draw + label)	3 drawing-response questions + favourite part	3/4 correct with identifiable response
Program Portfolio	All	Learner + Teacher	Collected artifacts + teacher notes	Evidence of growth across 6 units

7.4 Reporting & Family Communication

- Progress Notes: Brief written notes (3–4 sentences) shared with families after Units 2, 4, and 6, describing what the learner has achieved and one focus area for home practice
- Reading Log: A simple home reading log is introduced in Unit 4 — learners record each time they read (or are read to) at home, earning a stamp per session
- Celebration Certificate: All learners receive a personalized "LITTLE READERS Certificate of Completion" at the Session 6.6 celebration, signed by the teacher and recognizing specific achievements

Section 8: Materials & Resources

8.1 Core Classroom Materials

Books & Print

- "Brown Bear, Brown Bear, What Do You See?" – Bill Martin Jr. (Big Book version preferred)
- "The Very Hungry Caterpillar" – Eric Carle
- "Chicka Chicka Boom Boom" – Bill Martin Jr. (alphabet book)
- 6–10 simple decodable readers (CVC level): Oxford Reading Tree Biff Chip & Kipper (Stage 1+), Jolly Readers, or equivalent
- 2–3 Reader's Theater scripts per unit (teacher-created or adapted from folk tales)
- Big Book or projector for shared reading
- Environmental print samples (food labels, shop signs, classroom labels)

Manipulatives & Classroom Tools

- Alphabet letter tiles (one complete set per pair of learners)
- Magnetic letters and whiteboard (teacher)
- Personal whiteboards and dry-erase markers (one per learner)
- Elkonin sound box cards (pre-printed, laminated, 3-box and 4-box versions)
- Colored counters/cubes for phoneme counting (red/blue/red for C-V-C)
- Pointer (large for teacher Big Book, small for learners)
- Flashcard sets: alphabet letters (uppercase + lowercase), CVC word cards, sight word cards
- Word wall (large display space with pockets or Velcro for word cards)
- Story map graphic organizers (pre-printed, one per learner per Unit 6 session)
- Sand trays or foam trays for letter formation (Unit 3)
- Playdough for 3D letter making (Unit 3)

8.2 Digital Resources (Optional Enhancement)

- **Jolly Phonics App** (iOS/Android): Synthetic phonics instruction with songs and animations for each letter sound. Use as homework extension or early finisher activity.
- **Starfall.com** (Web, free): Structured reading instruction with interactive phonics and decodable books. Excellent for Units 3–5.
- **Teach Your Monster to Read** (iOS/Android): Gamified phonics and early reading practice aligned with UK structured literacy sequence.
- **Epic! Books for Kids** (Web/App): Digital library with read-aloud function for unlimited access to picture books. Ideal for Units 5–6 extension.
- **YouTube – Jack Hartmann Kids Music Channel**: High-quality phonics songs, sight word songs, and comprehension read-alouds. Free to use in classroom with projection.
- **Google Slides / PowerPoint**: Create custom phonics presentations, digital Elkonin boxes, and interactive sight word activities for whole-class delivery.

8.3 Teacher Reference Resources

- **Kilpatrick, D. (2015).** "Essentials of Assessing, Preventing, and Overcoming Reading Difficulties." Wiley. — Deep reference on assessment and phonemic awareness instruction.
- **Bear et al. (2019).** "Words Their Way: Word Study for Phonics, Vocabulary, and Spelling Instruction." Pearson. — Rich source of word sort activities for Unit 3.
- **Rasinski, T. (2010).** "The Fluent Reader: Oral and Silent Reading Strategies for Building Fluency, Word Recognition, and Comprehension." Scholastic. — Full method descriptions for Unit 5 fluency approaches.
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Section 9: Differentiation Strategies

Differentiation in LITTLE READERS is proactive, embedded, and invisible. It is not a set of separate modifications applied after the fact — it is the way every session is designed from the beginning.

9.1 Differentiating for Ages 5–6

- **Session Length:** Consider splitting 60-minute sessions into two 30-minute blocks if attention consistently wanes. Both blocks target the same objective.
- **Activity Design:** Increase proportion of kinesthetic and song-based activities. Reduce phonics writing tasks; prioritize oral and physical response. Use manipulatives over pencil-and-paper for all tasks.
- **Text Complexity:** Use wordless picture books for shared reading. Use 3–5 word decodable sentences (not full paragraphs).
- **Assessment:** Use observation and pointing tasks rather than written responses. Accept drawings as equivalent to written labels.
- **Grouping:** Seat 5–6 year-olds near the teacher during whole-class instruction. Increase 1:1 or small-group pull-aside time for Elkonin box work.

9.2 Differentiating for Ages 7–8

- **Metalinguistic Awareness:** Use explicit terminology (phoneme, segment, blend, vowel, consonant, CVC). Ages 7–8 can discuss language as a system and benefit from this conceptual framework.
- **Speed and Challenge:** Offer word ladders with CCVC/CVCC extensions once CVC is mastered. Provide "challenge card" extensions for learners who complete tasks early.
- **Independent Work:** Introduce personal phonics journals where learners write and collect new words they can decode. Begin independent (silent) reading in Units 5–6.
- **Peer Teaching:** Assign more advanced learners as reading partners for younger or lower-level peers — peer teaching deepens their own understanding.

9.3 Differentiating for L1-Literate Learners

- **Script Transfer:** If learners read in an alphabetic L1 (French, Spanish, Turkish), explicitly highlight similarities between L1 and English letter sounds. Learners will transfer phonological awareness skills rapidly.
- **Script Differences:** If learners read in Arabic, Urdu, or another non-Latin script, be aware that directionality (right-to-left) habits may initially interfere. Provide extra directional practice in Unit 1 without stigma.
- **Vocabulary:** L1-literate learners may have stronger receptive vocabularies. Accelerate to Unit 6 content connections (text-to-world, not just text-to-self) if comprehension is strong.

9.4 Differentiating for Learners with Learning Differences

- **Dyslexia Indicators:** If a learner shows persistent difficulty with phoneme segmentation and blending after Unit 2 intensive support, refer for specialist assessment. In the meantime: use multi-sensory Orton-Gillingham-aligned letter-formation practice; use larger fonts; provide extra time for all reading tasks.

- **Attention & Focus:** Reduce distraction in the visual field. Provide fidget tools during listening activities. Allow standing or floor sitting. Break activities into 5-minute micro-tasks.
- **English Language Proficiency Gaps:** If oral English vocabulary is very limited, pre-teach 2–3 key content words before each session using picture-word cards and L1 glossing. Do not withhold phonics instruction pending oral fluency — research confirms decoding can precede oral proficiency.

9.5 Extension for Advanced Learners

- **Above-Level Readers:** Identify learners who enter with some prior English reading ability. For these learners: accelerate to Units 3–4 directly; provide longer decodable texts; extend to CCVC/CVCC words and digraphs (ch, sh, th) as bonus phonics content.
- **Reading Journals:** Advanced learners begin keeping a personal reading journal in Unit 5, recording book titles, simple reactions ("I liked it / I did not like it / It surprised me"), and new words they want to remember.
- Challenge cards for each session are included in teacher notes to extend advanced learners without disrupting the class pacing.

Section 10: Program Evaluation Plan (ADDIE — Phase 5)

The LITTLE READERS evaluation plan uses the Kirkpatrick Four-Level Model (Kirkpatrick & Kirkpatrick, 2006) to assess program effectiveness at every level: from learner satisfaction to long-term reading impact.

10.1 Kirkpatrick Level 1 — Reaction

What did learners (and teachers) think and feel about the program?

- **Learner Reactions:** Gathered through smiley-face self-rating cards at the end of each unit (I loved this unit / It was okay / I did not enjoy this). Results are tracked to identify which units generate highest and lowest enthusiasm.
- **Teacher Reactions:** A 10-item post-program questionnaire is completed by delivering teachers covering clarity of materials, adequacy of session plans, appropriateness of pacing, and confidence in delivery.
- **Family Reactions:** A brief 5-question home survey (shared at the final celebration) gathers family perceptions of their child's engagement, attitude toward English reading at home, and visible confidence changes.

10.2 Kirkpatrick Level 2 — Learning

Did learners acquire the knowledge and skills targeted by the program?

- **Instruments:** All 7 summative assessments described in Section 7 directly measure Level 2 outcomes. Pre-program diagnostic data (Session 1.1 observation) is compared to end-of-program portfolio data.
- **Target:** At minimum 75% of learners achieve mastery threshold on 5 of 7 summative assessments. Learners below threshold in any area are flagged for supplemental support.
- **Data Review:** Teacher compiles assessment results in a class tracking spreadsheet (provided as reproducible in teacher materials). This data informs the Level 3 and 4 review.

10.3 Kirkpatrick Level 3 — Behavior

Did learners transfer and apply their reading skills beyond the program sessions?

- **Home Reading Logs:** Reading logs (introduced in Unit 4) track whether learners are independently seeking out English reading at home. Return rate of reading logs is tracked as a behavior indicator.
- **Classroom Transfer:** In Units 5 and 6, teachers document instances of learners spontaneously applying reading strategies (pointing to words, attempting to read environmental print, asking about book titles) in non-instructional moments. These anecdotal notes are included in the portfolio.
- **Follow-Up Observation:** If learners continue in EFL classes after the program, their next teacher completes a 4-week follow-up checklist noting reading behaviors in the new class context.

10.4 Kirkpatrick Level 4 — Results

What is the long-term impact of the program on learners' EFL reading trajectories?

- **Three-Month Follow-Up:** Where institutional capacity allows, a brief oral reading check (5 decodable sentences + 5 sight words) is administered 3 months post-program to assess retention of foundational skills.

- **Program Iteration:** The results of all four Kirkpatrick levels are reviewed by the curriculum designer (Rayene Medabis) at the end of each program cycle. Underperforming sessions are revised, pacing is adjusted, and new differentiation strategies are added based on real classroom data.
- **Longitudinal Indicator:** If learners proceed to a Cambridge Young Learners English (YLE) preparation program, their Starters-level performance serves as a long-term indicator of program effectiveness.

10.5 Program Review Cycle

Review Point	Timing	Who Reviews	Outcome
Formative Session Review	Every session	Delivering teacher	Adjust next session pacing; provide targeted re-teaching
Unit Review	End of each unit	Teacher + coordinator	Review assessment data; adjust upcoming unit if needed
Mid-Program Review	After Unit 3	Teacher + curriculum designer	Check pacing; revise Units 4–6 if needed
End-of-Program Review	After Session 6.6	Full team + Rayene Medabis	Full Kirkpatrick analysis; program revision plan
Annual Revision	Each academic year	Curriculum designer	Update materials, adjust scope based on learner cohort data

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